

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: What a surreal dream ... I slipped down a slimy slope.



Learning Outcome

Describe routines and regular activities in a wider range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Have you had any surreal dreams lately?
- Do you usually remember your dreams?

Can Do Statements

- I can say and use words with the combined sounds [s] and [l].
- I can describe the quality of an object or a person.
- I can stress new information.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa didn't have a nightmare **per se***... what kind of dream did she have?

* "Per se" is an expression meaning exactly.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** How have you been sleeping since we talked about it?
- Vanessa:** Well, I've been slowly trying to increase the number of hours I sleep each night. The other night I had a really strange dream.
- Sally:** You mean like a nightmare?
- Vanessa:** Not a nightmare, per se ... but it was very surreal.
- Sally:** Tell me about it!
- Vanessa:** Well, I was carrying a sledgehammer and wearing slippers. I was walking down a slippery slope somewhere familiar. I felt someone slap me on the back and then I slipped and rolled down the hill. I thought I was going to hurt myself, but then I fell into a soft, fluffy white cloud. I felt something slimy on my face and when I woke up it was my cat Ninja licking my face!
- Sally:** Wow ... that is the strangest story I've ever heard!
- Vanessa:** Yeah, definitely the weirdest time I've had sleeping in a while ... I don't know if that's a good thing or a bad thing.
- Sally:** Try to be optimistic! Maybe it's a sign ...
- Vanessa:** A sign of what?





Let's Practice!

Superlatives are the hardest words to pronounce!

Instructions: Underline all the superlatives in the paragraph and make new sentences with them.

I had the strangest time yesterday. My friend and I were walking down the longest street in the world. We both felt the slimiest stuff on our feet. When we looked down, we saw the strangest shoes ever! We both started laughing and then we slipped and rolled down the hill. It was a surreal moment ... good thing it was just a dream!



Let's Practice!

Vanessa describes a dream she had to Sally ... what happened?

Instructions: Read the text. Write the words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud with your partner. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

nightmare / per se / about / high school / kind / not sure /
current / ex-boyfriend / boyfriend / Cambridge / dream

Vanessa: The other night I had a really strange _____.

Sally: What _____ of dream? You mean like a _____?

Vanessa: Not a nightmare, _____ it was very surreal.

Sally: What was it _____?

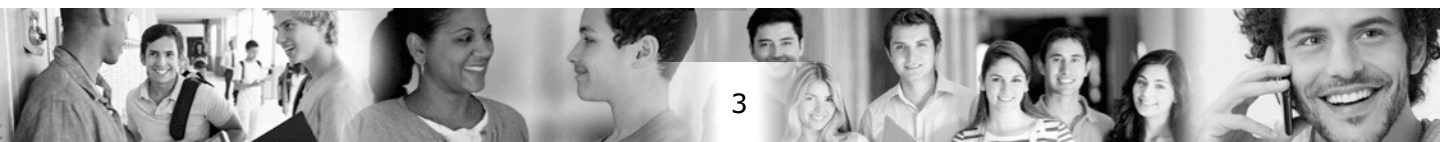
Vanessa: It was about my _____.

Sally: You mean, Marco? Your _____ boyfriend?

Vanessa: No ... I think it was about my _____. From _____.

Sally: From high school in _____?

Vanessa: I'm _____ ... I'm slowly starting to forget about it ...





Extension Activity

Write a dialogue about dreams.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- With a partner, write down 10 words that start with sl.
- Write a dialogue about a dream using these words.
- Practice reading the dialogue aloud, practicing the sl sound.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write down 10 words that start with sl.

☐ ☐

I write a dialogue with my partner about dreams using the words that start with sl.

☐ ☐

My partner and I practice the dialogue.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **sledgehammer** (noun): a heavy tool used for hitting large objects
e.g. I was carrying a sledgehammer.
- **slippers** (noun): a pair of shoes worn inside to keep your feet warm
e.g. I'm wearing slippers because my feet are cold.
- **slippery** (adjective): when a surface is difficult to stand on because it is wet or too smooth
e.g. I was walking down a slippery hill.
- **slimy** (adjective): feeling wet and sticky
e.g. The surface felt slimy.
- **slope** (noun): a hill
e.g. I was walking down a steep slope.
- **to slap** (verb): to hit with an open hand
e.g. I felt someone slap me on the back.
- **to slip** (verb): to fall and slide
e.g. I slipped down the hill.





Learning Points

Stressing New Information

When you want to stress new information, you use different intonation and stress on the "new" word or idea.

You usually stress content words in a sentence. Content words are the words that carry the most meaning (nouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs, etc.).

When you want to introduce new information in a conversation, you can choose to put the stress and the intonation on the "new" words. This helps the listener understand that you want to stress that word and that it is important.

Look at this simple conversation:

Tom: I **need** a **pair** of **shoes**.

Jason: What **kind** of shoes? ("kind" is the new information, "shoes" is the old)

Tom: **Dress** shoes.

Jason: Any **color** of dress shoes?

Tom: **Black** dress shoes.

When you stress these "new" words, your voice will rise slightly (intonation).

Linking and Deletion With Superlatives

You use a superlative adjective to express the highest of a quality. You use a superlative adjective to talk about one thing or person in a group of things. You always use *the* with the superlative.

In natural conversation, it is common to link and delete some sounds in the superlative adjective if there is a similar sound in the next word.

For example:

The strangest story.

You delete the 't' sound and link the 's' sound.

The stranges_story.

Sometimes this makes it hard to listen to native speakers talk. If you know the rule, you can listen better.

Practice reading these words aloud:

The smallest sweater = The smalles_sweater

The loudest truck = The loudes_truck

